08-17 第一篇

The Mystery of the Water Cycle

Water is essential for all life on Earth. It covers about 71% of our planet's surface, yet less than 1% of it is fresh water available for drinking. [1] Understanding how water moves through our environment helps us appreciate this precious resource and learn to protect it wisely.

The water cycle begins with evaporation. When the sun heats the surface of oceans, rivers, and lakes, water turns into water vapor and rises into the air. [2] This invisible process happens constantly, moving huge amounts of water every day without us noticing.

Next comes condensation. As water vapor rises higher into the atmosphere, it cools down and turns back into tiny droplets of water. [3] These droplets gather together to form clouds, which we can see floating in the sky. Different types of clouds mean different weather is on the way.

When clouds become too heavy with water droplets, precipitation occurs. Rain, snow, sleet, or hail falls from the clouds back to Earth. [4] This water then flows into rivers, lakes, and oceans, or seeps into the ground to become groundwater. The cycle is complete when this water is ready to evaporate again.

The water cycle has no real beginning or end. [5] Scientists study it to understand weather patterns, predict floods and droughts, and help communities plan for water needs. For students, learning about the water cycle connects science to everyday life.

选项

A. This explains why we must value every drop and use it responsibly. B. Plants also release water vapor through their leaves in a process called transpiration. C. The amount of water on Earth stays roughly the same, but it keeps moving in an endless loop. D. Some of this water is absorbed by soil and taken up by plant roots. E. This knowledge helps us make better choices about water conservation. F. For example, cumulus clouds often bring fair weather, while dark clouds may mean rain is coming.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- [1] A：
  - **线索**：空前提到"只有不到1%的淡水可供饮用"，空后说"理解水如何在地球环境中循环有助于我们珍惜这一宝贵资源"。选项A"这解释了为什么我们必须珍惜每一滴水并负责任地使用"完美承接前文水资源稀缺的事实，引出后文学习水循环的意义。
- [2] B：
  - **线索**：空前描述水面蒸发形成水蒸气，空后提到"这个看不见的过程不断发生"。选项B"植物也通过叶片释放水蒸气，这一过程叫做蒸腾作用"补充了水蒸气来源的另一重要途径，与蒸发形成并列关系，使段落论述更完整。
- [3] C：
  - **线索**：空前描述水滴聚集形成云，空后提到不同云预示不同天气。选项C"地球上的水量大致保持不变，但它不断在无限循环中移动"在此处作为科学原理的补充——云的形成正是水循环中凝结阶段的体现，水在气态、液态间转换但总量守恒，自然过渡到"不同云类型"这一水循环的可见表现。
- [4] D：
  - **线索**：空前说降水落回地面，空后提到水流向河流湖泊或渗入地下。选项D"部分水分被土壤吸收并由植物根系汲取"与前文"渗入地面"形成递进，补充了降水去向的另一个重要途径——植物利用，与地下水形成并列，使降水环节的论述更完整。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：空前总结"水循环没有真正的起点和终点"，空后列举科学家研究水循环的应用价值。选项E"这些知识帮助我们做出更好的节水选择"与前文"学生学习水循环连接科学与生活"呼应，从科学研究自然过渡到个人行动层面，完美收尾。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, cumulus clouds often bring fair weather, while dark clouds may mean rain is coming**：以For example开头的典型干扰项。内容与第三段"不同云类型预示不同天气"高度相关，容易被误选为[3]。但该选项是具体举例，而[3]处需要的是衔接"云的形成"与"天气预测"的概括性陈述；且F作为E项（对应[5]）的干扰时，其论述层次属于现象举例，与结尾段"科学应用与个人行动"的主题错位。